

Report marking scheme

ETC5543 Business analytics creative activity

11 September 2025

Rubric

Score	Description
90–100	The project report is outstanding in all respects; well presented, clear, concise, logical, and flowing. Few, if any, areas for improvement. Demonstrates a profound understanding of the problem and its context, provides a clear justification for the chosen approach, and offers many thoughtful insights.
80–89	Excellent in most respects; well organised, logical, and easy to understand. Demonstrates an excellent understanding of the topic, with a number of excellent insights. Some room for improvement in one or more areas.
70–79	Coherent, concise, and well written; easy to read but has a couple of minor shortcomings. Demonstrates a very good understanding of the topic, with a few good insights. Several areas for possible improvement.
60–69	Very good effort but has significant shortcomings in at least one area. Shows reasonable understanding of the topic, but lacks deep insights and may even misunderstand some issues.
50–59	Has some good points but is limited by major shortcomings. Mostly easy to read but incomplete or poorly organized. Shows a modest understanding of the topic but fails to identify some of the more obvious insights and implications of the results.
< 50	May have some good aspects, but otherwise mediocre. Often hard to read, with areas that are poorly organized. Shows a superficial grasp of the project and provides no sense of understanding why it was conducted or why the results might be interesting or useful.

For projects focused on tool development (e.g., R packages), the above descriptions should be interpreted appropriately. A tool would typically be designed to solve specific problems; the project report should describe the problem(s) being tackled, demonstrate how the tool helps to solve them, ideally evaluate how well it does so, and provide insights gained about the problem(s) and/or solution(s) as a result of carrying out the project.

Features of high quality reports

The following lists show features that we look for when assessing your reports. You can use these as a guide to help you produce high quality work.

Title and abstract

- Title is appropriate and captures the essence of the analysis.
- Abstract or summary is well written and contains key information: aims, methods, data, findings, etc.

Background, motivation

- Background is clearly outlined, and the analysis is well motivated.

Objectives, significance

- Analysis objectives are clearly stated, with brief information on the methods used, the data, etc.
- The significance and contributions of the analysis and/or methodology employed are clearly articulated and well-argued, and any novel features are outlined.

Methodology, data, results, discussion

- The methodology of the analysis is presented clearly.
- The methods used are appropriate for achieving the analysis aims, and any data limitations are clearly explained.
- Some form of diagnostics or robustness discussion/test of the method is provided.
- The conceptual/methodological complexity, the skills that the student learned from the work, the difficulties of the tasks completed, the workload undertaken, and aspects of innovation/novelty of the analysis.
- Contributions in data collection, processing, and visualisation.
- Contributions in coding for data processing, modelling and analysis.
- The functional aspects of any Shiny apps or other interactive tools are explained.
- Results are thoughtfully and constructively discussed, with links to objectives and insights.
- All data sources and data related work are clearly described either in main text or appendix.
- Designs for any Monte Carlo simulations are clearly described.
- Any main computation algorithms are clearly laid out or referred to source references.
- Software used is cited with links provided if possible.

Conclusion

- Highlights of interesting results/findings.
- Description of any policy/practical implications/significance of the analysis, linking back to the objectives.
- Limitations, caveats and future analysis.

Writing and presentation

- The writing of the report is clear, scholarly, eloquent, free from grammatical errors, and of the standard of a publishable report.
- The report has a nice flow, with well-structured sections.
- Variables are clearly defined, and a good choice of notation.
- Results are well organised and presented, and discussion has proper cross-reference to tables and figures.
- Tables and figures have appropriate titles and clear labels/captions offering sufficient information.
- Citation of literature is appropriate and reference list is of academic standard.